

In Mussaf for the first day of Pesach, in the paragraph of וּמִפְנֵי הַטָּעֲיוֹנוֹ - one of the most inspiring and beautiful paragraphs in our davening - we say the following: יְהִי רְצוֹן מִלְפָּנֶיךָ ה' אֱלֹהֵינוּ וְאַלֵּינוּ אֲבוֹתֵינוּ מִלֵּךְ רַחֲמָן שְׁתָּשׁוּב: וְתִרְחַם עָלֵינוּ וְעַל מִקְדָּשְׁךָ בְּרַחֲמֶיךָ הָרַבִּים וְתִבְנֶהוּ מְהֵרָה וְתַגְדֵּל כְּבוֹדוֹ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ - We express our yearning for the return of the Temple and for us to be restored to our homeland. אָבִינוּ מִלְפָּנֶיךָ גְּלוּת כְּבוֹד מִלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה - Please reveal to us the glory of your Kingdom quickly. The קשיא is this seems repetitive. We already said "Let the Temple return." What is being added by the next phrase, מְהֵרָה עָלֵינוּ מִלְכוּתְךָ כְּבוֹד מִלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה?

The machzor for Pesach brings the Vilna Gaon, who offers a fantastic vort on these פסוקים in our davening. He quotes a גמרא in ע"ב ע"ב חגיגה, which says that all of the מלאכים in שמים have שש כנפים שש - six wings, as is brought down in ו'ב' ישיעיהו. However, there is another pasuk in ו'א' יחזקאל which says וְאֶרְבָּעָה פָּנִים לְאֶחָד, implying that they have only four wings. The גמרא asks it's a סתירה, do the מלאכים have four wings or six wings? The גמרא answers: כָּאֵן בְּזִמְנֵי שְׁמֵי הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, כָּאֵן בְּזִמְנֵי שְׁמֵי הַמִּקְדָּשׁ, כָּאֵן בְּזִמְנֵי שְׁמֵי הַמִּקְדָּשׁ - when the Temple stood, the מלאכים had six wings, but when the Temple was destroyed, they lost two of their wings. This is incredible. What happens in the world has enormous effects in the world.

The גמרא asks: Which two wings were lost? The גמרא brings רב חננאל אמר רב who explains that the two lost wings were the middle wings, the ones used to say שירה. Since we are unable to say שירה properly in גלות, they, too, cannot say שירה. As it says (ישיעיהו ו'ב' ג') וְאֶל זֶה וְאֶל זֶה יִעֲרָף וְקָרָא זֶה אֶל זֶה וְאָמַר (ישיעיהו ו'ב' ג') וְאֶל זֶה וְאֶל זֶה יִעֲרָף וְקָרָא זֶה אֶל זֶה וְאָמַר. Those are the two middle wings.

The גמרא asks: What was written on those wings? He brings another מדרש that states: On those six wings it says, בְּרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹד מְלָכוּתוֹ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד. Which words are the two middle wings? כְּבוֹד מְלָכוּתוֹ. That's what we're saying in our תפילה: תפילה, the power of what we do here in the world. We say, אָבִינוּ מִלְפָּנֶיךָ גְּלוּת כְּבוֹד מִלְכוּתְךָ עָלֵינוּ מְהֵרָה, Bring back those two wings which have the words כְּבוֹד מְלָכוּתוֹ, and then we will be able to serve you to our ultimate degree in the Temple. המדרש, במהרה בימינו.

